

Product Overview

CampusCarbon is an AI-powered carbon footprint tracker built specifically for college students. Students log their daily habits — meals, commute, and energy usage — and instantly see their personal CO2 emissions score, compare with peers on a campus leaderboard, and receive AI-generated nudges to make greener choices. Built for the realities of student life in India and Southeast Asia: mess food, hostel rooms, college buses, and auto-rickshaws.

The Problem

2.55 tonnes avg annual CO2 per student (InnsPub 2022)	50%+ students have LOW carbon awareness (Academia 2025)	0 tools built specifically for campus life
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Existing tools like Joro require credit card linkage (irrelevant for most students). The WWF Footprint Calculator is a one-time quiz with no ongoing engagement. No tool exists that is built around the daily rhythm of campus life.

The Solution — Four Core Features

■ Daily Carbon Logger

A 3-tap logging flow for meal, commute, and energy. Each option shows CO2 in real time. Students can add custom options with their own CO2 values.

■ Carbon Score Dashboard

A visual ring-based score, 7-day trend chart, weekly average, CO2 saved vs average, streak counter, and campus rank — all on one screen.

■ Campus Leaderboard

All registered students ranked by average daily CO2. Peer competition drives engagement — the same mechanic that makes Duolingo sticky, applied to sustainability.

■ AI Coach (Groq / LLaMA 3.3 70B)

Conversational AI coach gives personalised, campus-specific advice referencing mess food, autos, and hostel energy use. Knows the student's live stats.

Technology Stack

Layer	Technology
Frontend	React 18 + Vite
Backend	Node.js + Express
Database	MongoDB Atlas (persistent, cloud-hosted)
AI	Groq API — LLaMA 3.3 70B Versatile (free tier)

Auth	bcrypt password hashing
Styling	Custom CSS + Outfit font

How This Maps to the Stage 1 Business Case

Problem Validation

Stage 1 identified students emit 2.55t CO2 annually with 50%+ unaware of their footprint. CampusCarbon directly bridges this awareness gap with a daily habit loop backed by real data.

Target User

Stage 1 defined urban college students aged 18-24 in India and Southeast Asia. Every feature reflects this: Indian transport modes (auto, Ola, college bus), Indian meal types, hostel energy use.

SDG Alignment

SDG 13 (Climate Action): each log creates measurable CO2 data. SDG 4 (Education): carbon literacy embedded in daily life. SDG 11 (Sustainable Cities): campuses as micro-sustainability communities.

Revenue Model

Stage 1 proposed a university SaaS licence (Rs. 2-5L/year) for ESG dashboards. The MVP builds the student-facing data layer that makes the institutional dashboard valuable for accreditation.

Go-To-Market

Stage 1 identified WhatsApp groups and sustainability clubs for first 100 users. The leaderboard is the product-led growth engine — one student joins, peers compete to rank higher.

3-Year Vision

Stage 1 projected 1M users across 500 universities, reducing 200,000 tonnes CO2/year. This MVP establishes the core habit loop, auth, persistent logging, and leaderboard that scales there.

Why This Is Defensible

- Behaviour-first design — built around a student's actual daily decisions, not generic carbon categories.
- Network effects — the leaderboard becomes more valuable as more students from the same campus join.
- Institutional lock-in — universities that licence the dashboard promote the app to students, creating a B2B2C flywheel.
- Data moat — longitudinal campus-level emissions data is a unique asset for climate research and ESG reporting.

Built for the hackathon. Designed to scale. ■